Zixuan "Zizi" Shao

UX Design · Creative Technology · Interactive Media

Brooklyn, NY

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Summary

Integrated Design & Media student at NYU Tandon with experience in UX research and usability testing. Builds projects in creative coding (p5.js, ml5.js), physical computing (Arduino), and motion capture / real-time 3D (Unreal Engine, MetaHuman). Seeking internships in UX / product design, creative technology, or interactive media.

Education

New York University, Tandon School of Engineering

Brooklyn, NY

B.S. in Integrated Design & Media (Expected May 2028) — *Jan. 2026 - Present*

- GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

Pratt Institute

Brooklyn, NY

Art + Technology, Digital Arts (transferred to NYU) — *Sep. 2024 - Dec. 2025*

- President's List: Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Experience

Xtraspots

New York, NY

Junior UX Designer Intern — *May. 2022 - Aug. 2024*

- Conducted user research on user needs and behaviors, turning insights into data-driven design recommendations.
- Created and maintained user personas and journey maps that aligned design decisions with users' needs and pain points.
- Supported usability testing sessions, identified friction in the user journey, and proposed actionable improvements.

KTD - Tibetan Buddhist Teaching Center

Woodstock, NY

Teaching Assistant & Interpreter (Volunteer) — *2019 - Present*

- Produce teaching materials and course plans, coordinate between lecturers and staff, and interpret English talks into Mandarin Chinese.

Projects

Broken Promises — Motion-Capture Short Film [Video]

Motion Capture Final Project, NYU Tandon (team of 3) — *Spring 2026*

- Co-produced a short animated drama spanning 12 scenes and 12 characters, built with Blender, MotionBuilder, Unreal Engine, and MetaHuman.
- Performed as a body and facial motion-capture actor; manually rigged character models and retargeted mocap data onto most of the cast.
- Built Unreal Engine environments and handled animation, camera, and rendering for 4 scenes using Level Sequencer; co-created the storyboard.

Let You Be You — Interactive LED Miniature Garden

Art and Technology Final Project, Pratt Institute — *Fall 2025*

- Built a light-responsive installation where an Arduino UNO and photoresistor light up hidden multicolor LEDs in the dark.
- Turned a concept about authenticity into physical interaction: each LED represents a hidden emotion or trait that "comes alive" only in the dark.

Creative Coding Reel [Video]

Creative Coding, Pratt Institute — *Fall 2025*

- Semester of interactive p5.js sketches: generative visuals, WebGL 3D, data visualization, and body / hand tracking with ml5.js.

Skills & Interests

UX & Design	User Research, Usability Testing, Personas, Journey Mapping, Figma
Programming	JavaScript (p5.js, ml5.js, WebGL), HTML/CSS, Python, Arduino
3D & Mocap	Unreal Engine, MetaHuman, MotionBuilder, Blender, Motion & Facial Capture, Lens Studio, ARCore
Media	Adobe Premiere, After Effects, Photoshop, CapCut
Languages	English, Mandarin Chinese
Dance	MegaCrew Finalist, Hip Hop International (HHI) USA Championship 2025, Los Angeles
Music	Piano (10 years)